the zebra's VOICE
2013•EDITION ONE

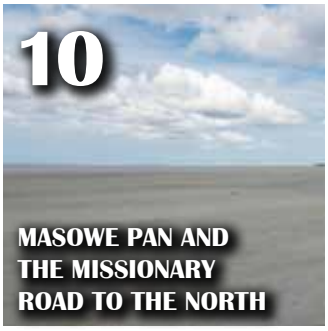
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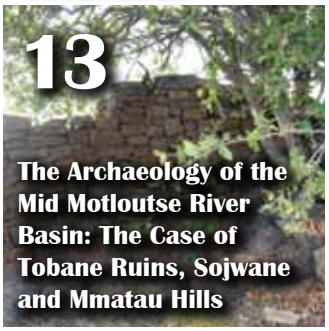
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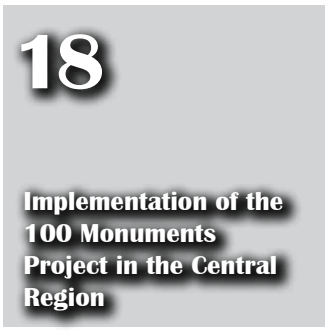
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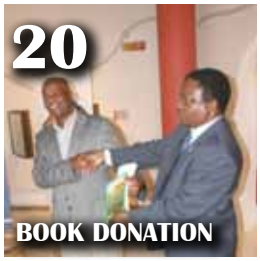




















The Zebra's Voice welcome articles, photographs and illustrations from those involved or interested in cultural and natural heritage.
Articles should be submitted on Mac/ Windows Microsoft Word including a brief biography and addressd to:

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Editor's note

Heritage tourism is catching up as a strong foreign income earner, not only in Botswana but the world over. It is therefore not surprising to see efforts being made all over the world to ensure the protection of heritage, at national and international level.

The 16th November, 2013 marked the 40th Anniversary of the World Heritage Convention. The World Heritage Convention is the only convention that brings the whole world together in the preservation of both cultural and natural heritage. At 40, the convention is ratified by 190 states with Botswana being one of them, a total of 962 sites in the World Heritage List, 745 of them cultural including our very own Tsodilo Hills, 188 natural and 29 mixed(both cultural and natural) in 157 States Parties.

Of note on reflections and future perspectives to mark this anniversary was the closing event held in Kyoto, Japan on 8th November, 2013. At this event emphasis on the importance of the World Heritage Convention was on the implementation of best practices and maintaining high standards in site management. This emphasis was emanating from different discussions and positions held in relation to the convention especially the IUCN Conservation Congress on 21st September, 2013 in Korea, in which Operational Guidelines for the World Heritage Convention were adopted. The guidelines will ensure that the convention, among other things, appropriately recognizes the rights of indigenous peoples and local communities in line with acceptable international norms and standards.

Here in Botswana, Department of National Museum and Monuments and stakeholders continue to ensure the protection, preservation and enjoyment of our heritage! Programmes such as 100 Monuments and the World Heritage Convention itself, are implemented to take stock of our cultural and natural properties and their value thereof. This is why Botswana as a State Party is currently a implementing a programme on the listing of the Okavango Delta as a World Heritage Site.

Lastly, we are hopeful that the Okavango Delta will be listed as a World Heritage Site to make it a second for Botswana.

Malomatsebe





Okavango aerial View (J Bestelink)

Listing the Okavango Delta as a World Heritage Site

By Segametsi Radise

Since early 2011, the Government of Botswana as a state party to the UNESCO 1972 Convention Concerning the Protection of World Cultural and Natural heritage is working towards the listing of the Okavango Delta as a World Heritage Site. Botswana ratified the UNESCO 1972 Convention on November 23rd 1998 and thus committed to ensuring the identification, protection, conservation, presentation and transmission to future generations, its cultural and natural heritage considered to be of outstanding universal value to humanity.

World Heritage is an idea that was proposed by the United States in 1965 to preserve the world's superb natural and scenic areas and historic sites for the present and the future of the entire world citizenry. The idea was then presented by the International Union for the Conservation of Nature (IUCN) to the 1972 United Nations conference on Human Environment in Stockholm and formally adopted on 16th November, 1972 as the Convention Concerning the Protection of the World Cultural and Natural Heritage.

A World Heritage Site is a place such as a forest, mountain, lake, desert, monument, building, complex or city that is listed by UNESCO as of special cultural or physical significance ("World heritage":http;//whc.unesco.org/en). Currently, Botswana has one World Heritage Site; Tsodilo Hills which is a cultural site.

Okavango panorama (J Bestelink)

Why list the Okavango Delta?

The listing of the Okavango Delta was initiated by the Ministry of Environment, Wildlife and Tourism (MEWT) in fulfillment of Botswana's obligations to the UNESCO 1972 Convention. The listing process is coordinated by MEWT and implemented in partnership with relevant stakeholders.

Botswana believes that since: (i). A World Heritage Site should be exceptional. The Okavango Delta measuring over 16000 km, is the largest inland delta in the world in a desert environment. There is no other delta with the same setting and or form. (ii).The scope of the convention is global with respect to the significance of the properties to be protected. In a comparison of seven globally important wetlands, of which six are located in the tropics and sub tropics, the Okavango Delta has the highest number of reptiles and bird species, second highest number of plant and mammal species and third highest number of fish species (Junk et al, 2006). In addition the Okavango river and the delta are among a few of the world's river systems that are still technically 'wild'- meaning that to date there are no dams or human structures that impede its natural functioning. (iii) The value of a property makes it outstanding and universal. The Okavango Delta supports over 120 000 people by providing fresh water, food, building materials, medicinal plants as well as employment through a viable tourism industry.

Does the Okavango Delta satisfy the UNESCO Criteria for listing as a World Heritage

In terms of satisfying the natural heritage criteria for listing sites, the Okavango Delta satisfies three out of the four natural heritage criteria stipulated in the operational guidelines of the World Heritage Convention as

- It contains areas of exceptional natural beauty and aesthetic importance
- It is an outstanding example of ecological and hydrological processes since it supports an outstanding variety of forms of life including 150 species of mammals, over 500 species of birds, 90 species of fish as well as plants, reptiles, invertebrates and amphibians.
- It supports globally threatened and endangered species including wild dogs, cheetahs, lions as well as sitatunga antelopes.

Work done so far...

Progress made in the listing process includes: community consultations in November 2011 and August 2012 in villages around the delta as well as a holding stakeholder conference in Maun in June 2012. MEWT is to submit a dossier to support the listing to the World Heritage Committee at the end of September, 2012. Botswana is confident that the recommendations for Okavango Delta listing would be successful. World heritage status will bring growth in the tourism at the delta and strengthen good conservation practices from international support and therefore contribute towards the attainment of our nation's Vision 2016 pillar of A Prosperous, Productive and Innovative Nation.

Gchwihaba Caves Project: The Search Extends To Aha Hills

By Mosarwa Babutsi

The Ngamiland District in northwest of Botswana is a host to several unique cave systems, with known caves at Aha, Gcwihaba and Koanaka Hills. These Caves Systems are situated to the west of the Okavango Delta in the extreme northwestern part of the country, within a radius of 50km to the Namibian border. According to Gabadirwe et al (2007), the search for more caves is stimulated by the fact that cave systems are invaluable sediment traps as they preserve botanic and faunal information. They also provide an understanding of early human behavior. Therefore the preservation of these caves is crucial as it will promote the documentation and further understanding of the paleoenvironment, particularly aspects of palaeoclimatology and palaeoecology. Research undertaken at these caves, will contribute to the expansion of knowledge of the area, especially on climatic changes, hydrology, geology, biology, archaeology and paleontology, (Gabadirwe et al 2007).

Although there are several caves in the area, only the Gcwihaba Caves have been the subject of several scientific studies and surveys which include the initial survey by the first Bechuanaland Geological Survey in 1943, Falcon College in 1969, a resurvey by Garner and Ritter in 1993(Gcwihaba Management Plan) and the current Gcwihaba Caves Exploration Project with less activity in the Aha Sinkholes and the Koanaka Caves. The Botswana National Museum decided to extend the current cave searching project to Aha Hills. These are a west- east trending range of linear hills thatstraggle the Botswana-Namibia boarder. They break the monotony of the flat Kalahari landscape (Gabadirwe et al -2007). This survey is part of the Gcwihaba Caves Exploration Project and is conducted by the Botswana government. The two main objectives of this project are:

1. To survey the Aha Hills and search for unknown caves in the hills.
2. To further survey the two known sinkholes for possibilities of finding the broad cave at the base.

The hills were surveyed using a simple basic method that involved walking up and down the hill to search for caves. Three groups of eight (8) people were formed with a space of 10-15m between two people within a group. Group members climbed the hill on one side and came down on another side. Therefore they covered the entire hill, minimizing the chances of missing the potential cave that could be encountered there. The 1980 aerial photographs of the area taken at a scale of 1: 40 000 were made available for photogeological interpretation. A Global Positioning System (GPS) was used to document the position of interesting features.

The communities of Quangwa and Xaixai villages and Kihabe Prospecting Site employees were interviewed about the two known sinkholes as well as the possibility of finding any other caves in the area. Unfortunately they did not know of any.

Like the Koanaka and Gcwihaba rocks, the rocks of Aha Hills are a part of the Damara Mobile Belt. According to Loxoton et al (1981), the Aha Hills represent a tightly folded predominantly carbonate sequence dominated by pink and grey dolomitic limestones.

Dolomite is inter-bedded with chert and for this reason, Carney et al (1994) referred to this succession as a dolomite-chert sequence with both oolitic and columnar stromatolites sporadically observed. Red very fine-grained calcareous sandstone alternates with cherty dolomite. Quartz in association with chert was found in the form of veins, which run parallel to bedding, nodules and large irregular bodies throughout the outcrop.

The mechanism that led to the formation of sinkholes with less secondary cave formation is still unknown. However, Garner and Ritter (1994) suggested several mechanisms that could lead to the formation. These include Artesian Spring and Corrosion and Mixing. Lack of a downward slope in Aha sinkholes that would allow running water in and out of these cravens acted as resurgent exit of ground water(as spring).

A Museum geologist and members of the Botswana Defence force team were trained to use an absailling rope and other caving equipment such as hardhats, torches gloves and safety harness. Once they descended to the cave floor, they found that both sinkholes were hosts to various bat and insect species. The base of Waxhu



Figure 1: Museum geologist descending into the cave.



Figure 2: Team members who managed to descend in to the sinkhole.

South is oval shaped with elongation in the southeast-northwest direction. Waxhu North was difficult to access due to its instability. However one member of the South African Speleological Association managed to reach the bottom and reported seeing a Kudu skull on the cave wall.

The search in Aha Hills did not yield any new caves. There is need to establish why these hills do not have horizontal caves like those at Gcwihaba and Koanaka. However, the presence of sandstone sequences in Aha Hills might have contributed to the lack of development of a large cave system with a lot of cave formations.

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Kwa kgaolong ya Ngamiland, e e kwa bokone-bophirima jwa Botswana, go na le magaga kwa dithabeng tsa Aha, Gchwihaba le Koanaka. Magaga a, a ko bophirima jwa makgobokgobo a Okavango. A ko bophirima jwa Botswana, gaufi le molelwane wa Namibia. Go batliwa ga magaga a mangwe go tlhotlhelediwa ke go bo go nna teng ga one go tsaya karolo mo tshomarelong ya dimela le diphologolo tse di fitlhelwang mo lefelong leo.

Ka jalo go botlhokwa thata go somarela magaga a, ka go rotloetsa go somarela kitso ka ga one. Dipatlisiso tse di dirilweng kwa magageng a di tla thusa mo go atoloseng kitso mabapi le phetogo ya seemo sa loapi, lobopo, metsi, popego ya diphologolo,dimela le batho mmogo le masalela a ditso

Le ntswa go na le magaga a le mmalwa mo lefelong le, magaga a Gchwihaba ke one fela a go dirilweng dipatlisiso tsa boranyane mo go one. Dipatlisiso tsa ntlha di ne tsa dirwa ke ba Bechuanaland geological survey ka ngwaga wa 1943 le Falcon College ka ngwaga wa 1969. Dipatlisiso tse di ne tsa dirwa gape ka ngwaga wa 1993 ke Garner le Ritter. Gape go na le lenaneo le le tsweletseng la go batla magaga a masha koo.

Lephata la Ditso le Ditsa Tlholego le tsere tshwetso ya go atolosa patlo ya magaga mo dithabeng tsa Aha tse di mo mololwaneng wa Botswana le Namibia. Dipatlisiso tse di dirilwe ke goromente wa Botswana mme maikaelelo a matona a tsone ke;

1. Go batlisisa gore a ga go na magaga a go sa itseweng ka one mo dithabeng tseo.
2. Go tswelela ka dipatlisiso mo magageng a mabedi a a itsiweng go bona gore a go na le kgonagalo ya gore a bo a ikadile ka fa tlase ga lefatshe.

Dipatlisiso mo dithabeng tse di ne di dirwa ka mokgwa o o motlhofo. Go ne go pagamiwa go ba go gololwa thaba go batliwa legaga. Go ne go na le dithopha di le tharo, sengwe le senngwe sa tsone se na le batho ba robabobedi. Go ne go na le sekgala sa dimmithara di le lesome le botlhano fa gare ga batho ba le babedi mo setlhopheng sengwe le sengwe. Ditlhopha di ne di tshwanetse go pagama thaba e ntlha e nngwe di bo di e fologa ka fa go e nngwe . Ba ne ba dira jalo mo thabeng yotlhe gore go seka ga nna le kgonagalo ya gore go seka ga bonwa legaga le le batliwang. Go ne go dirisiwa dinepe tse di tserweng mo phefong tsa ngwaga wa 1980 go lemoga mafelo a go nang le kgonagalo ya gore go bo go na le magaga mo go one.

Banni ba metse ya Quangwa le Xaixai mmogo le babereki ba Kihabe Prospecting Site ba ne ba bodiwa dipotso ka magaga a mabedi a a setseng a itsewe le gore a ba akanya fa go na le a mangwe a a ka tswang a ise a bonwe mme ba araba ka gore ga ba itse.

Mokgwa o magaga a bopilweng ka one o santse o sa itsiwe. Le fa go ntse jalo Garner le Ritter ba ntshitse mogopolo wa gore magaga a bopilwe ka mekgwa e e farologaneng. Go tlhoka go nna teng ga mokgokolosa o o ka bong o dira gore metsi a tsene a bo a tswe mo thabeng ya Aha go dirile gore go nne le motswedi foo. Moitseanape wa tsa lobopo go tswa kwa Lephateng La Ditso Le Ditsa Tlholego le setlhopha sa masole ba ne ba rutuntshiwa go dirisa didirisiwa tse di dirisiwang mo legageng jaaka megala, makarapa le diatlana. E rile ba tsena kwa tlase ga legaga, ba fitlhela bo mmamanthwane le ditshedinyana.

Go ne go le thata go tsena mo legageng le le kwa bokone le le bidiwang Waxhu ka ntlha ya go tlhoka go itshetela ga lone. Mongwe wa setlhopha sa South African Speleological Association o ne a kgona go tsena mme a bolela fa a bone legata la tholo mo lebotaneng la legaga.

Dipatlisiso tse di dirilweng mo dithabeng tsa Aha di ne tsa seka tsa kgona go senola magaga a masa. Go tshwanetse gore go batlisiwe gore ke eng dithaba tse, di sena magaga a a ikadileng jaaka tsa Gcwihaba le Koanaka.



Photo3-1 Caption

Masowe Pan And The Missionary Road To The North

By Onkgopotse R. Moseki

The historic road to the north has nothing to do with the modern Gaborone – Francistown A1 road. This road was used by travelers and missionaries travelling from the southern parts of the country to the northern interiors as far as Bulozi in present day Zambia and Mashonaland in Zimbabwe. Some of those people were the Reverend Dr David Livingstone, Thomas Baines, the Greene's brothers and missionaries such as Reverend John Mackenzie, Gould Adam. The road to the north was linked to major villages in the southern parts of Botswana which were linked to Mafikeng. In the 19th century, the main north south road was not located along the present day line linking Lobatse, Gaborone, Mahalapye, Serule, and Francistown. The old road followed a route linking Kanye, Molepolole, Shoshong and Serowe through Lephephe. The main attraction features of this route included Lephephe wells and Masowe Pan. Other sites that were found along that route were Marele Engravings, Sunyaneng and Pitsane. The travellers and missionaries had to cross sandy areas, ascend hills and negotiate several water courses before arriving at Shoshong, which had established itself as a major trading town in Southern Africa by the mid 1800s.

Masowe Pan located about 10 km south west of Kodibeleng village on the fringes of the Kalahari Desert was an important site along this route during those historical times. The pan is formed on a sedimentary rock terrain made up of sandstones of the Karoo Super group. It holds some water for a considerable part of the year.This is where early travelers and missionaries



Photo3-2 Caption

stopped to water their horses and oxen, repair their ox drawn wagons and refresh before proceeding with their journey. They could also hunt game and possibly acquire fresh beef from surrounding cattle posts. The area remains an important watering hole for domestic stock to neighbouring cattle posts during the rainy season (Mabuse et al 2010: 121).

Memories of the travellers who used to water their animals at this place are now left in the form of engravings found on a low lying sandstone boulder. This historic art takes the form of inscriptions of names of some of these travelers and a drawing of an ox drawn wagon pulled by about six to eight oxen which has since disappeared. During a survey of the site in 2010, one of the residents of Kodibeleng Mr Tjako Mpulubusi recalled seeing the engraving when he visited Masowe Pan in 1982. He also stated that these engravings were probably made by the Basarwa people who met traders and missionaries at the pan. Although the local people suspect that the engraving might have been vandalized by people who visited the site, it is also possible that it disappeared due to the weathering of the sandstone boulder on which it was made. Destruction of heritage sites contravenes the Monuments and Relics Act of 2001, which considers it an offence for anyone to disturb, remove or damage any archaeological remains in the country. Whosoever vandalized this site deprived future generations the chance to see these heritage resources.

Today Masowe Pan appears unattractive and lifeless during the dry season. Several open wells that used to be dug at the pan during the dry season are no more as the local people have sunk boreholes for the purpose of watering their animals.

However, not all is lost at Masowe Rock engravings. On the same rock a man named L.R. Tarr has engraved his name. This man was popularly known as Raditau by the local people as he had a special interest in hunting lions. Tarr is believed to have endeared himself to farmers in the area because he hunted and killed many of the lions that attacked and killed their livestock. The pan also has engravings of traditional games such as mhele. The next time you visit the pan, do not forget to keep your eyes wide open. It is still possible to find the famous ox wagon engraving as we believe that it might still be lying somewhere covered by the sand.

List of Informants

Mr. Tjako Mpulubusi – Consultant and resident of Kod ibeleng

Kgosi F.B Kgamane - Senior Chief of Shoshong

Mr. K. Madiabaso – Shoshong village elder

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Bogologolo tsela e e tswang borwa e ya kwa bokone e ne e dirisiwa ke baeti le bareri ba lefoko la Modimo go ralala lefatshe leno go ya go fitlha le kwa Bulozi le Mashonaland. Mafelo a a kgatlhisang a a neng a bonwa mo tseleng e ke didiba tsa Lephephe, letsha la Masowe, ditshwantsho tsa mo matlapeng tsa kwa Marele, Sunyaneng, Pitsane le Shoshong. Baeti ba le bareri ba lefoko la Modimo ba ne ba nosa dipitse le dipholo tsa bone ha didibeng tsa Lephephe le ha letsheng la Masowe.Gape ke gone ha ba neng ba ema teng go baakanya dikoloi tsa bone tsa dikgomo le go itapolosa.Ha ba le ha letsheng la Masowe ba ne gape ba tsoma diphologolo le go batla nama ya kgomo mo merakeng e e gaufi.

Letsha le la Masowe le dikhilomithara di le some kwa borwa bophirima jwa motse wa Kodibeleng.Mo go lone lefelo le go na le ditshwantsho tsa mo matlapeng. Go dumelwa gore ditshwantsho tse di ka tswa di dirilwe ke Basarwa ba ba neng ba kopana le baeti le bareri ba lefoko la Modimo fa letsheng le. Sengwe sa ditshwantsho tseo, se se neng se supa koloi ya dikgomo e e neng e gogiwa ke dipholo di ka nna thataro go ya kwa go borobabobedi, ga se sa tlhole se le teng. Le fa go na le dipelaelo tsa gore setshwantsho se se sentswe ke batho ba ba neng ba ntse ba etela letsha leo, go na le kgonagalo ya gore se bo se nyeleditswe ke go gotlhega ga letlapa le se se neng se le mo go lone.Go senya ditshwantsho di tshwana le seo go kgatlhanong le molao wa tshomarelo mafelo a a nang le bokao jwa ditso, ngwao le tlholego.Ha e le gore tshenyo e e ne e dirwa ke motho, o rontshitshe dikokomane tsa rona tshono ya go bona bontle joo jo e leng boswa jwa ngwao.

Le fa go ntse jalo go santse go na le maina a a kwadilweng mo matlapeng ke L.R. Tarr
yo banni ba tikologo eo ba neng ba mmitsa Raditau.O ne a ratiwa ke barui ba kgaolo eo ka a ne a tsoma ditau tse di neng di ba bolaela leruo. Gape go na le ditshwantsho mo matlapeng tse di supang metshameko e e tshwanang le mhele. Go santse go na le tsholofelo ya gore gongwe setshwantsho sa koloi ya dikgomo se santse se le teng golo gongwe se khurumeditswe ke motlhaba.



Photo3-3 Cartion

Sojwane Ruins

The Archaeology of the Mid Motloutse River Basin: The Case of Tobane Ruins, Sojwane and Mmatau Hills.

By Abel A. Mabuse



The mid Motloutse Basin consists of several seasonal tributaries which drain their waters into the Motloutse River. These rivers played an important role in supporting the development of farming communities in the region during the last 1000 years. Remains of these farming societies are found at sites such as the better studied Khami period ruins of Majande (Tsheboeng 1995) on either banks of the Majande River, Sampowane Ruins on the eastern banks of Sampowane River (van Waarden 1998) and Sojwane to the south of Motloutse River near Tobane. Just 10 km north of Selebi Phikwe, are remains of an elite Zimbabwe period ruin known as Mothudi (located on the flood plains of the Motloutse River). To the north west of Mothudi, there is another similar ruin known as Mokoswane. . The development of Early Farming Communities began with a people known archaeologically as Zhizo people who first settled in eastern Botswana around AD 700. Their sites have so far been recorded near Mmadinare (Campbell et al 1996), Mothudi Ruin (Kokeli 2010), and at the lesser understood sites of Mmatau, Sojwane and Tobane Hills (Mabuse et al 2010).

The evolution of Early Farming Communities such as the Zhizo along the Motloutse basin, particularly along the Shashe-Limpopo confluence is better studied and documented by Munyaradzi Manyanga and Sarah Mothulatshipi for their PhD studies. Alec Campbell's survey of Letsibogo Dam in 1988 recorded several Zhizo sites around Mmadinare along the Motloutse and Sedibe rivers. Campbell et al (1996) mitigation work at Letsibogo Dam recovered long and linear shifting Zhizo settlements along the foot of some hills. At Letsibogo, these sites are usually located away from the river banks and are characterised by concentrations of thick burnt clay or daga. A survey by the University of Botswana (UB) and University of Dar es Salaam (UD) has uncovered Zhizo ceramics at Mothudi (Kokeli 2010) This discovery suggests that numerous daga features found at Mothudi belong to the Zhizo occupation period. This makes them at least several hundred years older than the late Zimbabwe period ruins often associated with them (Mothulatshipi, personal communications2011). Mabuse et al (2010) noted multiple occupation levels at Tobane Ruins, Sojwane Hills and Mmatau Hills in February 2010.

Tobane Ruins is a national monument located on the western edges of Tobane Village among a cluster of granite kopjes. An Archaeological survey conducted by Abel A. Mabuse and Mpho Basebi in July 2010, revealed a total of 3 typical Zhizo sites overlain by what appears to be a Khami settlement and historic pottery. To the north of the ruin, there is a large midden with some typical Zhizo ceramics, animal bones, ostrich eggshell beads, daga features and some Late Stone Age artifacts. This midden suggests multiple occupation of the site. There is also a large midden on top of Tobane Hill with some undecorated pottery, animal bones and a few Late Stone Age tools. Several stone features which resemble granary platforms are also found at the site. This suggests that grain supplies were stored on top of the hill where the ruler of the settlement resided. This observation has been made at other commoner Khami sites such as Vumba and some sites along the confluence of the Shashe-Tati Rivers (Campbell 1991a). The site of Tobane Ruin extends further to the south west into a modern



Sojwane Snake

dumping site where undecorated potsherds can still be found in some disturbed parts. Informants from Tobane village told us that some human skeletal remains were uncovered during the development of the dumping site over 10 years ago. There is also a small midden with undecorated Khami pottery, animal bones, few daga features and some disturbed stone features which share similar characteristics with some commoner Khami sites recorded at Letsibogo by Campbell et al (1996).

Sojwane Hills is an Ancient Monument with many cultural features ranging from Sojwane Snake Trail, Ancestors Cave, Raining Making Shrine, A Zimbabwe period stone wall named Sojwane Ruins, and some Zhizo settlements (Mabuse 2010). These features have important tangible and intangible cultural heritage values attached to them. Sojwane Snake Trail is believed to be the place where a huge snake swallowed a young herd boy named Sojwane. The snake is believed to have opened up a big hole on the ground and swallowed Sojwane after being provoked by the noise of the boys while resting underground (Moseki, 2010 personal communications). The boy was never seen again. The ancestors cave is a small crevice between two rock boulders that were intentionally modified into a circular cave near Sojwane Trail. The cave is used as a place where offerings in the form of traditional beer are made to ancestors. The beer is usually left overnight in the cave to appease ancestors during times of need such as drought sprees and epidemics. It is also left there during other important communal functions. Legend has it that in times when the ancestors are happy, they drink all the beer overnight. During troubled times, the beer remains untouched for days and even weeks as a sign that the ancestor are not happy (Kgosi Motlhasedi 2010 Personal Communication).



Ancestors Cave at Sojwane Hills



Front part of Sojwane Ruins

To the west of the ancestors cave and Sojwane Trail lies the Hosana Dancing Spot. The area is used as a dancing spot and shrine for raining making ceremonies where some hosanna dancers used to congregate to pray for rain and conduct rituals before proceeding to Njelele, the famous rain making shrine located in Zimbabwe (Mabuse et al 2010). On the southern edge of the Ancestors Cave, on a raised platform, are the remains of a Zimbabwe stone walled settlement. This ruin is made up of a single courtyard at the front and a few abutting walls that measure no more than 1.5 metres in height. Some religious groups use the front of the courtyard for performing rituals and making offerings to the ancestors. No systematic archaeological survey has been conducted at the site as yet and it is anticipated that future research will help unearth the role of small scale sites like this one in sociopolitical organisation of Late Farming Communities on the south of Motloutse River. There is also a midden with Zhizo pottery which was discovered on the foot of the hill directly west of the Ancestors Cave.

Mmatau Hill is located in mophane woodland and it looks sacred. Oral traditions collected at Tobane suggests that this hill, often referred to as Lentswe le le bogale is dangerous and cannot be approached by anyone except rain making spirit mediums. Locals believe that Mmatau is a dwelling place for ancestors (Badimo) who often reveal themselves to extremely lucky people in the form of a wild goat, sheep or a large snake.It is also believed to be a rainmaking shrine.Smoke is often seen coming from the top of the hill to mark the coming of the rainy season. Archaeological surveys conducted in February and July 2010 by the author, Mpho Basebi and some village elders yielded several middens around the hill along with Zhizo ceramics, animal bones, granary platforms and daga features (Mabuse 2010). The presence of granary platforms and Zhizo ceramics suggests that a rich agriculturalist society was established in the vicinity of Tobane during the 1st Millennium. The evidence from Mmatau and Sojwane Hills supports Kokeli's (2010) conclusions that the development of farming communities probably followed a regional approach whereby sites began as small settlements which increased in size and organisation leading to occupation of other areas along the Motloutse basin.

In conclusion, the evidence amassed from preliminary archaeological investigations of Tobane Ruins, Sojwane and Mmatau Hills suggests three important issues around Tobane. The area was instrumental in the development of a localised Zhizo culture. Secondly, these sites eventually developed into larger settlements and often moved away from the rivers and exploited fertile land in the area for agricultural purposes. By around AD 1200 these populations had been affected by regional developments associated with the rise of several chiefdoms in eastern Botswana leading to the development of complex states such as Mapungubgwe, Great Zimbabwe and the Khami states. (Van Waarden 1991). Finally, investigations also show that contemporary communities continue to use some of these sites as rain making shrines and places of ancestral worship. Sojwane and Mmatau Hills are venerated and considered to be an abode of ancestors and spirits. Further research is needed to investigate the human occupation of these hills in ancient times The resuscitation of traditional practices and promotion of cultural traditions at Tobane Ruins, Sojwane and Mmatau Hills are essential to make these sites more interesting.

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Noka ya Motloutse le dinokana tse di tshelang mo go yone go dumelwa fa di thotheleditse balemi barui ba ngwao e e bidiwang ya Zhizo go thibelela mo matshitshing a tsone . Matlotla a balemi barui ba, a fitlhelwa kwa Majande, Mothudi, kwa letamong la Letsibogo go bapa le Mmadinare le Tobane kwa dithabeng tsa Sojwane le Mmatau .

Thaba ya Tobane ke lefelo le le nang le bokao jwa ditso le ngwao le le fitlhelwang kwa bophirima jwa motse wa Tobane. Dipatlisiso di supa fa batho ba Zhizo ba kile ba nna mo dithabeng tse bogologolo. Fa tlase ga lentswe le go na le masalela a marapo a diphologolo, dibaga tse di dirilweng ka dikgapha tsa mae a bo mmantshe le didirisiwa tse di dirilweng ka matlapa. Gape go na le masalela a difalana a a supang gore thobo e ne e bewa kwa godimo ga thaba kwa Kgosi e neng e nna teng.

Mo dithabeng tsa Sojwane go fitlhelwa matlotlo a ngwao le tlholego a a nang le bokao jo bo nonofileng mo tumelong ya batho ba kgaolo ya Tobane. Go na le motlhala wa noga e go dumelwang fa e meditse modisa yo o bidiwang Sojwane. Gape go na le legaga le go obamelwang badimo mo go lone.Bogologolo go ne go dirwa bojalwa jwa Setswana bo bo bo tlogelelwa Badimo mo legageng le ka dinako tsa meletlo e e haphegileng le fa go na le matshwenyego a a tshwanang mauba le malwetse. E ne e re ha ba itumetse ba lale ba bo nole bosigo jwa lone letsatsi leo. Ha ba sa itumela ba ne ba sa bo nwe bo bo bo nna foo lebaka le le leele. Kwa bophirima jwa motlhala wa noga ya Sojwane, go fitlhelwa lebata la Dihosana. Go bolelwa fa lefelo le le boitshepo thata ka ele gone fa dihosana di binelang teng go kopa pula mo badimong.

Thaba ya Mmatau e e kwa botlhaba jwa motse wa Tobane, go dumelwa fa e le bonno jwa badimo ba ba bonwang ba le mo setshwanong sa podi, nku ya naga kgotsa noga. Gape e kgona go kaya fa pula e tloga e phaila ka go ntsha mosi le go tshikinyega. Dipatlisiso di supa fa lefelo le ele mangwe a matlotla a batho ba ngwao ya Zhizo ka go fitlhetswe mo go lone masalela a a tshwanag le a a fitlhetsweng mo matlotleng a mangwe a bone.

Go lemosega fa dithaba tsa Tobane, Sojwane le Mmatau e le mafelo a a tlotlegang a go dumelwang a na le sedimo. Go tlhokega gore Lephata la Ditso Le Ditsa Tlholego le nonotshe tshomarelo ya mafelo a le go rotloetsa batho ba Tobane go tshegetse ngwao ya bone gore ba kgone go ngokela bojanala mo kgaolong e.

Implementation of the 100 Monuments Project in the Central Region

By Powell Motsumi

The 100 Monument Project is part of Botswana National Museum's mandate to develop outstanding heritage sites that have the potential to be tourist destinations. The project is part of attempts by the government to diversify the tourism industry. This project is being implemented through various phases that include the survey of the monuments, assessment of their outstanding heritage value, design and installation of signage, opening up of trails and access roads as well as hiring of custodians. The main aim of the implementation phase was to open up access roads and trails through clearing the vegetation cover at certain monuments after the realization that routes leading to such monuments were disappearing due to continuous growth of vegetation.



Caption 5-1

The other aim of the project was to collect and document information on how the local communities relate to these heritage sites. Teams of museum professionals were deployed throughout the country to work with the local communities and other government departments in order to achieve the overall aim of this project. Sites visited in the Serowe area include Bosutswe, Khubuladintsa, Phokgommme, Taukome, Thataganyane, Sekgoma's House Swaneng Hill, Sokwe Forest as well as Majojo. This implementation phase began in June and ended in October 2010.

During the process it was noted that our sites generally need urgent attention. They look abandoned and insignificant yet they hold the nation's rich history. The overall management of these sites is not up to the standard expected, perhaps due to the common problem of lack of funding. Therefore conservation measures need to be put in place as that would extend the life span of these rare sites. They are very important since they have economic, educational, historical and religious value. Because of the values attached to these monuments by the local communities, the Botswana National Museum decided to utilize the Ipelegeng programme to engage the local communities in the development and conservation of these monuments. Through this programme, the local communities got an opportunity to learn about the importance of heritage resources and why it is essential to protect them. The project also proved to be benefitial to the local communities since it encourages the spirit of self- reliance. The other obvious benefits derived from the project include creation of employment opportunities for about 150 people in the area. This means that the project also managed to disengage these people from alcohol abuse and crime usually associated with unemployed youth.

The Ipelegeng programme is administered by the Ministry of Local Government and implemented by various District Councils. Engagement of the local people to open up trails and access roads was done in two ways. In big villages and towns, hiring was done by the Department of Labour whilst in small villages the Village Development Committee was given the responsibility to hire any physically able Batswana at the Kgotla. All the people hired had to produce proof of a functional Omang card in order to qualify for employment. Priority

was given to people living at cattle posts in instances where monuments were found near those cattle posts. The standard number of employees was 16 people. The numbers of males and females were expected to be equal in order to achieve gender balance. However, in some instances where there would be a need to cut big trees, more men were hired to help improve service delivery.

The role of the museum is to supervise casual labourers and enlighten them on how they should preserve heritage resources. They are empowered through sharing with them information pertaining to heritage management. Then they are able to share that knowledge with the rest of the community.

Generally the hundred monument project has been a success. However, there have been some challenges encountered during the process of implementation. Some of the casual labourers absconded from work, citing low wages as a discouraging factor. Other challenges were unavailability of camping equipment and protective clothing.

Lenaneo la tlhabololo ya matlotlo a ngwao le tlholego a le lekgolo ke tsela nngwe e Lephata La Ditso Le Ditsatlholego le lekang ka yone go kabakanya bojanala jwa lefatshe la Botswana. Lenaneo le le itebagantse le dintlha di le mmalwa jaaka ditshekatsheko tsa boleng jwa matlotlo a le go dira matshwao a a supang kwa mafelo a a leng teng. Ditiro tse dingwe tse di dirwang ka lenaneo le ke go rema ditlhare mo ditseleng le mo mebileng e e dirisiwang go etela matlotlo a mmogo le go thapa batlhokomedi ba one.

Mangwe a maitlamo a lenaneo le e ne e le go dira ditshekatsheko tsa gore batho ba dirisa matlotlo a jang le gore a a na le bokao bongwe mo matshelong a bone. Go diragatsa maitlamo a, Lephata La Ditso Le Ditsatlholego le ne la bolotsa letsholo la bodiredi jwa lone go ya kwa matlotlong a. Bodiredi jwa lephata bo ne jwa etela metse le metsana e e gaufi le matlotlo a mme jwa ikgolaganya le banni ba koo mo go diragatseng maikemesetso a lephata. Mafelo a a neng a etelwa mo kgaolong ya Serowe a akaretsa Bosutswe, Khubuladintsa, Phokgomme, Thataganyane le a mangwe.

Mangwe a mafelo a a ne a lebega a sa tlhokomelesega le fa ntswa a na le bokao jo botona mo setshabeng sa Botswana. Go botlhokwa gore seemo sa matlotlo a, se tsibogelwe gore a seka a nyelela kana a senyegela pele. Mangwe a matlotlo a, a ngoka bajanala mme a tsise dipoelo tsa madi fa mangwe a one a na le bokao jwa thuto, tumelo le ditso mo Batswaneng bangwe. Ke gone ka moo Lephata La Ditso le Ditsatlholego le neng la bona go tshwanela go dirisa lenaneo la Ipelegeng go tlhabolola mafelo a. Selo se se ne sa thusa batho kwa magaeng go ithuta ka botlhokwa jwa tshomarelo ya matlotlo a. Gape lenaneo le le ne la tlhama mebereko ya batho ba ka nna lekgolo le masome a matlhano mo kgaolong ya Serowe.

Lenaneo la Ipelegeng le rulaganngwa ke Lephata la Dikgaolo. Go thapa batho ka lenaneo le gone go dirwa ka ditsela tse pedi. Mo metseng ya setoropo Lephata La Tsa Pereko ke lone le neng le thapa batho. Mo magaeng,dikomiti tsa ditlhabololo tsa metse (VDC) ke tsone di neng di dira tiro ya go thapa.G ore motho a hiriwe ka Ipelegeng, o tshwanelwa ke gore a bo ale Motswana ebile a na le omang yo o mo tirisong.Mo mafelong mangwe, banni ba meraka ba ne ba neelwa tshono ya go nna bone ba ba tlhapiwang pele fa e le gore meraka ya bone e gaufi le mafelo a ba yang go direla mo go one. Mo mafelong a, gone go tlhapiwa palo e e lekalekanang ya bomme le borre go diragatsa maitlamo a tekatekanyo ya bomme le borre mo meberekong.

Lephata La Ditso Le Ditsatlholego le ne le itebagantse le go rutuntsha badiri ba ba thapetsweng lenaneo le ka ga tshomarelo ya matlotlo a gore ba anamisetse kitso e kwa baaging ba bangwe ba metse ya bone. Gape le ne le netefatsa gore ga ba senye matlotlo ao fa ba rema ditlhare mo ditseleng tse di yang kwa go one. Dikomiti tsa ditlhabololo tsa metse di ne di dirisanya le lephata leno go bona gore go dirwa se se tshwanetseng mo mafelong a.

Mo go diragatseng lenaneo le go supagetse fa go na le dikgwetlho di le mmalwa tse di tshwanetseng go sekasekwa. Dikgwetlho tse di akaretsa letlhoko la dikoloi, go sa theogeleng sentle ga batho ba ba tlhapiwang ka lenaneo la Ipelegeng le letlhoko la didirisiwa tsa babereki jaaka ditante, diaparo tse di sireletsang badiri mo dikgobalong le tse dingwe.

Caption 5-2



BOOK DONATION

By Berlinah Motswakhumo

It was an occasion to remember when Debswana donated 100 copies of a book titled The Plants Of The Okavango-A field Guide by Karen and William Ellery. The move was a gesture of support for the Okavango World Heritage listing process

The books were handed over by the Group Manager Mr Boyce Sebetela who pointed out that his company decided to collaborate with the authors of this book so that those who want to learn more about nature especially trees may do so from that book. He said out of the P75 000 spent on the research carried out as well as the publishing of the book Debswana contributed P50 000. He said it was its duty as a company that operates in Botswana to take part in environment protection activities. Mr Sebetela said this shows that his company does not just care about making money but also cares about the environment all over the country, not just in the areas where they operate.

He said that the book was easy to comprehend even if one does not know much about ecology and vegetation .He noted that however Batswana do not read much but warned that if they do not read what the authors of this book wanted to share their efforts and the funds used would go to waste. He urged those interested in plants and nature to read the book in order to be able to market the tourism industry in the country.

When receiving the donation the Permanent Secretary in the Ministry of Environment, Wildlife and Tourism Mr Samuel Rathedi said that the gazetting of sites as national monuments and their listing as World Heritage Sites is a process that needs to be supported by extensive research. He said such information is important as it is a continuous process indicating the value of the site. He said therefore it is a guiding tool for the sustainable development of sites. He said Botswana is currently engaged in the process of listing the Okavango Delta as a World Heritage Site. However for the site to be listed extensive research



Photo6-1 Caption

information has to be gathered over the years which will be used to compile a supporting dossier. He said there was a site working committee based in Maun which was working on different chapters of the dossier. Mr Rathedi pointed out that the book being donated by Debswana had come at the right time as it would support the Okavango Delta dossier. He said it would assist the site working committee with information to be incorporated into the dossier and equip libraries to cater for the expected increased interest in the Okavango Delta.

Mr Rathedi stated that the listing process is an expensive exercise estimated at P1 million to cover production, research study and equipment. He said he was grateful to Debswana for contributing to the process and for being a consistent partner in the sustainable development of heritage resources. He hailed Debswana for having supported Tsodilo Community Trust to the tune of P10 million to implement development projects in Tsodilo and P1million to support the Gcwihaba exploration project. He noted that it is important to have information on our heritage and it is up to us to read that information and teach our children about it. He said we are not a reading nation but we should be aware that in order to be informed we have to read, internalize that information so that we may be able to impart it to the outside world



Caption6-2



Caption6-3



Caption6-4



Majande

Sustainable Development of Shoshong - Bobirwa Region Heritage Sites for Tourism

By Abel A. Mabuse; Onkgopotse R. Moseki; John Abbey; Marumo Marumo; Kgosietsile Lemson, & Letso Mhale

E ne e le letsatsi le le sa ka keng la lebalesega motlhofo jaaka fa ba Debswana ba ne ba abela Lephata La Ditso le Ditsa Tlholego dibuka di le lekgolo tsa setlhogo se se reng "The plants of the Okavango-A field Guide" e e kwadilweng ke Karen le William Ellery. Se e ne e le sesupo sa gore ba Debswana ba eme nokeng maiteko a lephata a go kwadisa makgobokgobo a Okavango jaaka lefelo la mafatshefatshe la ditso le ngwao.

Dibuka tse di ne tsa abiwa ke mogolwane wa kompone eo rre Boyce Sebetela.O ne a bolela gore kompone ya ga gabo e tsere tshwetso ya go dirisanya le bakwadi ba buka e gore ba ba batlang go ithuta ka tlholego bogolo jang ditlhare ba ithute jalo mo go yone.O kaile gore mo mading a selekanyo sa P75 000 a a dirisitsweng mo dipatlisisong le mo go gatisiweng ga buka e, Debswana e ntshitse P50 000. O bile a re ke tiro ya kompone ya gagwe jaaka fa e direla mo Botswana go tsaya karolo mo ditirong tsa tshomarelo tikologo.O rile se se supa fa e sa kgatlhegele go dira madi fela mme e kgathala le ka tikologo mo lefatsheng leno lotlhe , e seng mo mafelong a e direlang mo go one fela.

Rre Sebetela o boletse fa buka e e le motlhofo go tlhaloganyesega le fa motho a sa itse go le kalo ka tsa dimela le tikologo. O supile gore le fa go ntse jalo tshaba ya Botswana ga e bale thata mme a tlhagisa gore fa batho ba sa bale buka e maiteko a a dirilweng ke bakwadi ba yone e tla bo e le lefela.O kgothaditse ba ba nang le kgathego mo dimeleng le mo tlholegong go bala buka e gore ba kgone go bapatsa bojanala jwa lefatshe leno.

Erile a amogela mpho eo mo boemong jwa lephata mokwaledi mogolo mo lephateng la Tikologo, Diphologolo le Bojanala rre Samuel Rathedi a bolela gore go tlhongwa ga mafelo a bosetshaba a a nang le bokao jwa ngwao le tlholego go nna a boditshabatshaba ke tiro e e tshwanetseng go engwa nokeng ke dipatlisiso . O ne a re kitso e e kgobokanngwang ka go dira dipatlisiso tsa go nna jaana e botlhokwa ka e kaya boleng jwa mafelo a go nna jalo.O tsweletse a re lefatshe la Botswana le mo thulaganyong ya go kwadisa makgobokgobo a Okavango jaaka lefelo la mafatshefatshele le nang le bokao jwa ngwao le tlholego. O tlhalositse gore le fa go ntse jalo gore go dirwe jalo go tshwanetse ga tsaya dingwaga go dirwa dipatllisiso mme kitso e e kgobokanngwang e bo e dirisiwa go tswa ka mokwalo o o tlhalosang ka botlalo ka lefelo leo. O rile ke gone ka moo go nang le komiti e e direlang kwa Maun e e dirang mokwalo wa go nna jalo.

Rre Rathedi o ne a supa gore buka e lephata le e fiwang ke ba Debswana e tsile ka nako e e siameng ka e tla tlaleletsa mokwalo oo. Gape o kaile ha tiro ya go kwadisa makgobokgobo e le turu ka e tsile go lopa sedikadike sa dipula se se tla bong se dirisediwa go dira dipatlisiso, go gatisa mekwalo e e tlhokafalang le go reka didirisiwa. O lebogetse Debswana go bo e nnile le seabe mo thulaganyong e ka se se thusa mo tlhabololong ya matlotlo a ngwao le tlholego a lefatshe leno. O bile a lebogela le go bo kompone eo e thusitse ka didikadike tse some tsa dipula gore go tle go dirwe ditlhabololo kwa Tsodilo le sedikadike sa dipula tse di neng tsa dirisediwa dipatlisiso kwa Gcwihaba. Rre Rathedi o ne gape a gakolola gore go botlhokwa gore re le Batswana re bale re bo re nne le kitso ka boswa jwa lefatshe la rona le go fetisetsa kitso eo kwa baneng ba rona.Le ene o ne a iteela kobo moroko mafoko a gore tshaba ya Botswana ga e ea itlwaetsa go bala mme a swetsa ka gore re tshwanetse go bala le go boloka kitso e re e anywang eo mo ditlhaloganyong gore re kgone go e arogana le batho ba bangwe ba mafatshe a sele.

There are 26 heritage sites located in the central and eastern parts of Botswana that are being developed for tourism purposes as part of the 100 monuments project. This project is a noble idea that aims to empower local communities through creation of employment opportunities. The project also aims to promote the establishment of income generating activities such as the revival of cultural practices among local communities, the production and selling of curios as well as the formulation of community trusts to develop and manage cultural resources in a sustainable way. It is essential to note that ever since independence, the tourism industry in Botswana has been skewed towards the marketing and promotion of wildlife resources in places such as the Chobe National Park, Moremi Game Reserve, Okavango Delta and Makgadikgadi Pans among others.

Although the protection of heritage sites began as early as 1938 in Botswana (Campbell 1998), efforts



Lekopole



Granary bin near Lepokole rock paintings



Sojwane Snake trail at Sojwane Hills

to develop heritage sites for tourism purposes only began in the 1990s. Over the last 10 years, there have been some concerns over the role of cultural heritage sites in tourism development. The Botswana National Museum's plan to develop 100 monuments for tourism purposes will certainly help answer some questions about the conservation status of heritage sites and their poor contribution in the tourism sector in the past. Several organizations, the media and other concerned groups have pointed out that ecotourism has not been significant in Botswana's archaeological, cultural and historical sites. It has been indicated in the Botswana Tourism Master Plan that most of these heritage sites are so poorly developed that they cannot be viewed as tourism attraction areas. The report also indicated that these sites are often poorly conserved and prone to vandalism. (ARCA Consulting 2000). As a result, various concerned groups have over the years called for the development of these heritage sites alongside major tourism destinations for purposes of diversifying the tourism sector.

Over the last 40 years, the Botswana National Museum has only managed to develop and open up 12 heritage sites for tourism purposes. These sites are Tsodilo World Heritage Site, Gcwihaba Caves, Moremi Gorge, Lekhubu, Old Palapye, Domboshaba, Mogonye, Mamuno, Majojo, Kolobeng, Manyana and Matsieng. At these sites, employment of site custodians, development of site trails, offices and some toilet facilities has been achieved. It is important to point out that the management of Botswana's heritage sites has faced some serious challenges over the last 40 years. These set -backs have in many ways hampered the development of these sites to acceptable standards that meet the needs of tourists. The most outstanding challenges include inadequate funds to provide basic facilities such as site offices, ablution blocks, interpretation centres and development of marketing strategies. Other problems are lack of skilled manpower to devise management strategies for the sites over the years, lack of community involvement and contestation of cultural landscapes among various sectors of the society have also contributed towards the poor development and management of Botswana's prime heritage sites. Another contributing factor that led to poor development of these heritage sites is adoption of inappropriate heritage management styles at some of the sites (Mabuse et al 2010:1)

Even though the development of some of these heritage sites has been faced with many challenges, communities living near them have benefited through creation of employment opportunities, training of local guides and engagement in partnerships with the Botswana National Museum in the management of some of these heritage sites. A classical example of a heritage site that has benefitted local communities is Lekhubu National Monument. This is the only heritage site in Botswana where relevant management practices have yielded tangible benefits to the local communities through engagement in a partnership with the Botswana National Museum through Gaing'o Community Trust (Mabuse & Tlhako 2009).

Developing heritage sites through the 100 Monument Project accords the Botswana National Museum an opportunity to reflect on the effectiveness of heritage management practices adopted over the last 40 years. It also provides the department with the chance to identify the means through which some of the challenges faced can be addressed. It is essential to consider adoption of relevant management strategies unique to these heritage sites. This will help ensure active involvement and participation of local communities in the daily management of these important cultural resources. This idea is in line with a resolution made at the last Director's Seminar of the Africa 2009 Programme on the Management of Immovable Cultural Heritage in Africa held in October 2009 in Mombasa, Kenya. At this important gathering, the role of the local communities in management of cultural heritage was summarised as follows;

"Acknowledging the important role that communities ... have played and continue to play in conservation and management of heritage resources. The Directors resolved that efforts should be made to:

• Encourage State parties to put in place policies and legislation that will enable local communities to participate in the management and conservation of heritage

• Ensure community and local authority participation and involvement in heritage conservation and management as well as in training programmes;

• Ensure specific training for communities living around World Heritage and other national sites ;

• Ensure that benefits from the sites accrue to the community."

The most prominent of the 26 sites found in the region mentioned above include, rock art sites such Marele Engravings and Masowe Pan near Kodibeleng and Lepokole Rock Paintings at Lepokole). There are Toutswe hilltop settlements such as Toutswemogala Hill and Pitsane Hill and Historic settlements such as Old Shoshong at Shoshong and Old Palapye near Malaka. Towards the eastern part of Botswana are stone walled settlements such as Majande near Tshokwe, Mziligomo near Semolale and Tobane ruins near Tobane. There are also mythic hills such as Sojwane and Mmatau Hills near Tobane and the rain making shrines of Sekgobokgobo.

In conclusions, it is essential to mention that these heritage sites occur as various landscape features which range from hilltop settlements, historic trees, natural gorges, prehistoric ruins, rock paintings, sacred hills, shrines and historic settlements. The majority of them are located near settlements and people in those areas use them for different purposes. These uses are viewed by the authors as a means through which suitable management practices can be established to ensure preservation of these important cultural resources. In order for these sites to be effectively developed, it is important to establish their heritage value, package them into heritage trails and finally link them with major tourist destinations and facilities such as hotels, accommodation amenities, craft centres, parks and game reserves.

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Go na le mafelo a a nang le bokao jwa ngwao le tlholego a le masome a mabedi le borataro a a ko botlhaba le bogare jwa lefatshe la Botswana a e leng mangwe a a lekgolo a a tlhabololwang gore a kgone go dirisiwa mo bojanaleng. Ditlhabololo tse ke mogopolo o montle thata o o itebagantseng le go fa batho ba ba mo tikologong ya matlotlo a dithata ka go ba tlhamela ditiro. Ditlhabololo tse gape di itebagantse le go dira madi ka go tsosolosa dingwao tsa merafe eo. Gape batho ba kgona go dira ba bo ba rekisa dithoto tse di dirilweng ka diatla. Go botlhokwa go lemoga gore fa e sale boipuso, bojanala jwa Botswana bo ntse bo remeletse thata mo mafelong a diphologolo a a tshwanang le la Chobe, la Moremi mmogo le makgobokgobo a Okavango le letsha la Makgadikgadi .

Le ntswa go sireletsa matlotlo go sale go simologile ka ngwaga wa 1938 mo Botswana (Campbell 1998), go a tlhabololela bojanala go simolotse fela ka dingwaga tsa bo 1990. Mo dingwageng tse di lesome tse di fetileng, go nnile le dingongorego ka go tlhoka go tlhabolola mafelo a a nang le bokao jwa boswa jwa ngwao le tlholego. Maikaelelo a Lephata la Ditso le Ditsa Tlholego a go tlhabolola mafelo a go nna jaana a le lekgolo gore a dirisiwe mo bojanaleng a tla thusa go rarabolola seemo se. Mo dingwageng tse di masome a mane tse di fetileng, Lephata la Ditso le Ditsatlholego le kgonne go tlhabolola le go bula matlotlo a le lesome le bobedi gore a dirisidiwe bojanala. Matlotlo a ke dithaba tsa Tsodilo tse e leng lefelo la mafatshefatshe le le nang le bokao jwa boswa jwa ngwao le tlholego, magaga a Gcwihaba, kgophu ya Moremi, Lekhubu, Old Palapye, Domboshaba, Mogonye, Mamuno, Majojo, Kolobeng, Manyana le Matsieng. Kwa mafelong a go thapilwe batlhokomedi ba one, ga tlhabololwa ditsela, ga agiwa diofisi le mantlwana a boiteketso.

Go botlhokwa go lemoga gore batsamaisi ba mafelo a a nang le bokao jwa boswa jwa ngwao le tlholego mo Botswana ba lebagane le dikgwetlho mo dingwageng tse di masome a mane tse di fetileng. Kgwetlho e tona thata e ne ya nna letlhoko la madi a a ka dirisiwang go aga diofisi, matlwana a boiteketso le botlhapelo, fa baeng ba ka bonang kitso teng le go tlhabolola maano a ipapatso. Go tlhaela ga kitso le maano a ipapatso mo dingwgeng tse di fetileng, letlhoko la seabe sa batho mo tikologong ya mafelo a le dikgotlhang fa gare ga makalana a farologaneng a sechaba mabapi le tiriso ya mafelo a go nnile le seabe mo go tlhokeng go tlhabologa ga one. Le ntswa go nnile le dikgwetlho mo go tlhabololeng mangwe a matlotlo a, batho ba ba nnang mo tikologong ya one ba ne ba kgona go bona ditiro, go rutuntshiwa, go nna bakaedi le go tshwaraganela tlhokomelo ya mafelo ao le ba Lephata la Ditso le Ditsa Tlholego. Lekhubu ke lone fela lefelo la mofuta oo mo Botswana le go tsamaisiwang sentle ga lone go ntshitseng maduo a a bonalang. Se se kgonnwe ka tirisanyo mmogo ya Lephata la Ditso le Ditsa Tlholego le lekgotla le le tsamaisang lefelo le,le le bidiwang Gaing-O (Mabuse & Tlhako 2009).

Go tlhabolola matlotlo a ngwao le tlholego a le lekgolo mo Botswana go fa Lephata la Ditso le Ditsa Tlholego tshono ya go sekaseka mekgwa ya tshomarelo ya mafelo a. Gape go thusa lephata go tla ka megopolo ya gore dikgwetho tsa bogologolo di ka fenngwa jang.

Mafelo a a nang le bokao jwa ngwao le tlholego mo dikgaolong potlana tsa Shoshong le Bobirwa a akaretsa lefelo la botaki kwa Marele, letsha la Masowe kwa Bophirima jwa motsana wa Kodibeleng le dikgaga tse di mo dithabeng tsa Lepokole. Mangwe a mafelo a, ke metse ya bogologolo e fitlhelwang mo godimo ga dithaba jaaka kwa Toutswemogala le Pitsane kwa Bophirima jwa Shoshong. Kwa botlhabatsatsi jwa Botswana, go fitlhelwa matlotla a bogologolo a ageletsweng ka marako jaaka a Majande, Mziligomo le Tobane.

Gore mafelo a tlhabololwe sentle, go botlhokwa go itse boleng jwa one, go supa ka fa a golaganang ka teng ka boone le ka fa a golaganang ka teng le mafelo a mangwe a bojanala jaaka diotele,mafelo a go rekisiwang dithoto tse di dirilweng ka diatla le mafelo a diphologolo.



On top of Lepokole



Chapmans Baobab

GWETA VILLAGE: AN IDEAL DESTINATION FOR TOURISTS

By Ontlametse Ntebang

The dusty village of Gweta serves as a gateway to the Makgadikgadi Pans, Ntwetwe Pan, Nxai Pan and Sowa pan. The name Gweta is derived from croaking sounds made by large bullfrogs. These frogs bury themselves in the sand for most parts of the years awaiting the rainy season to provide sufficient moisture to allow them to come out of hibernation and mate. Gweta is located almost in the centre of prominent pans of the Makgadikgadi palaeolake systems. To the west of the village lies the Makgadikgadi Game Reserve; a famous and important ecological system that supports the migration of animals such as Zebras and Hartebeesst. To the north west of the village lies Nxai Pan National Park which complements the migration of animals. The two destinations are home to many animal and plant species which are adapted to living in salt pans). Makgadikgadi Pans attract wild animals such as elephants, kudu, giraffes, zebras, hartebeests and antelopes which congregate along the Boteti River when pans and ponds in the area are dry. Shallow pools along the river provide a reliable source of water in the Makgadikgadi Pans Game Reserve.

The area around Gweta is home to several fascinating heritage resources which complement an experience of wildlife in the area. This paper explores some of these important heritage sites and shows why it is essential for them to be developed into prominent tourist destinations.

Baines Baobabs

Baines Baobab is a National Monument located about 100km west of the village of Gweta on the edges of Kudiakam Pan. These baobabs were made known to the outside world by Thomas Baines who painted them in 1862. 200 m to the south east of this cluster, there is an unnamed solitary baobab dubbed the Prodigal Son (Mabuse & Tlhako 2009). There is a well kept dry campsite with a simple environmental friendly toilet and a shower at the site.

Greene's Baobabs

Greene's Baobab is a National Monument located approximately 23 kilometres south of Gweta. The baobab served as important feature in early travellers' maps during their journeys into the interior of the country. It was documented during the Greene Expedition of the late 1880s. There is an inscription of the names of the Greene brothers and many others who claim to have visited this National Monument. To the southwest of the baobab, about 300 metres from Baines Baobab tree there is a small forest of palm trees that add a spectacle to the otherwise featureless area. Within this cluster of palm trees, there is a 'magic anthill' locally known as Xhotsie. It is alleged to have been used by Basarwa hunters to appease the ancestors while on their hunting spree. This anthill was initially a Motswere (Combretum imberbe) tree stump. At the anthill, there are several artifacts including pieces of cloth, tins, bullet cartridges, charcoal and many other items which are believed to be offerings made to the ancestors.

Chapmans Baobab

35 kilometres south east of Gweta village, there is another huge baobab called Chapman's Baobab. It is also known as the "Seven Sisters" in reference to its characteristic multiple trunk – like branches. The local people refer to it as "Xaugam", meaning a lion's tail in Setswana.This baobab is named after an explorer named Chapman who passed through the Makgadikgadi Pans in his journey into the interiors of the country in the late 1870s. To the south of the baobab, there is a cattle post with an impressive kraal that has deposits of cow dung that are about half a metre high. Further south in the Ntwetwe Pan is Jack's Camp, a popular tourist destination where one of the largest stone tools from the Makgadikgadi Pans can be found.



Kraal near Chapmans baobab



A broken hand axe on the pan margin

Nxghaishini Pan

Nghxaishini Pan is located about 25 kilometres north of Gweta. T his is the only documented National Monument in Botswana with stone age tools, hunting blinds, iron implements, bullet cartridges and fossilised faunal remains (Robbins and Murphy 1998). Within an area of approximately 700 × 600 metres there are fossilised bones of various animalsas well as hand axes, cores, choppers and several flakes. This site was probably occupied by Homo erectus people 1.5 million years ago and they used multipurpose tools for butchering animals and for cutting wood. They might also have used wooden clubs and sharp sticks as simple spears for hunting some animals whose remains are found in the pan. Elephants, kudu, duikers, lions, and different bird species frequent the pan during the rainy season, which makes the National Monument interesting to tourists and researchers. The presence of hunting blinds and recent bullet cartridges suggest that the site is still an important spot for hunters

The development of heritage sites in the area will in many ways contribute towards the growth of the economy of Gweta village. There are plans by the Botswana National Museum to install signage and information boards. The local people will in future be engaged through the Ipelegeng project to open up access roads and trails leading to these heritage sites. There will also be a site office with a small exhibition showing hunting practices at Nxghaishini during the Stone Age period. Guided tours to Chapmans and Greene's Baobabs in the Ntwetwe Pan as well as trips to Nxai Pan going through the famous Baines Baobabs will be arranged. The Mathekele thatched Planet Baobab lodge, Gweta Lodge and the charismatic Jack's Camp in the Ntwetwe Pan contribute towards Gweta becoming a mini-tourism hub of the Makgadikgadi Pans.. Sustainable utilisation of these heritage sites with the help of local people can help them to play a role in the development of the local tourism industry and the preservation of environmental resources. This can in turn contribute to the diversification of the economy.



Hunting blinds at Nxghaishini



A broken hand axe on the pan margin

The development of heritage sites in the area will in many ways contribute towards the growth of the economy of Gweta village. There are plans by the Botswana National Museum to install signage and information boards. The local people will in future be engaged through the Ipelegeng project to open up access roads and trails leading to these heritage sites. There will also be a site office with a small exhibition showing hunting practices at Nxghaishini during the Stone Age period. Guided tours to Chapmans and Greene's Baobabs in the Ntwetwe Pan as well as trips to Nxai Pan going through the famous Baines Baobabs will be arranged. The Mathekele thatched Planet Baobab lodge, Gweta Lodge and the charismatic Jack's Camp in the Ntwetwe Pan contribute towards Gweta becoming a mini-tourism hub of the Makgadikgadi Pans.. Sustainable utilisation of these heritage sites with the help of local people can help them to play a role in the development of the local tourism industry and the preservation of environmental resources. This can in turn contribute to the diversification of the economy.

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Gore motho a kgone go ya kwa matsheng a makagadikgadi, Ntwetwe, Nxai le Sowa o tshwanetse go feta ka motse wa Gweta. Kwa Bophirima jwa motse o go na le lefelo la diphologolo la Makgadikgadi.Kwa bokone bophirima jwa one go na le lefelo la diphologolo la Nxai. Mo tikologong ya motse o go na le mafelo a a nang le bokao jwa ngwao le tlholego.Dikhilomithara di le lekgolo kwa bophirima jwa Gweta go na le ditlhare tsa mowana tse di itsegeng ka di ne tsa tshwantshiwa ke motaki Thomas Baines ka 1862. Kwa lefelong le go na le fa baeng ba ka tlhomang ditante tsa bone
teng mmogo le ntlwana ya boitiketso e e nang le fa go tlhapelwang teng.

Dikhilomithara di le masome a mabedi le boraro kwa borwa jwa Gweta go na le ditlhare tse dingwe tsa mowana tse di biditsweng ka bomorwa Greene ba e leng bangwe ba baeti ba ba fetileng mo lefelong leo ka dingwaga tsa bo 1880.Teng go fitlhelwa mekwalo e e supang maina a batho ba ba kileng ba etela koo. Gape go na le seolo se se neng se dirisiwa ke Basarwa go itumedisa badimo ba bone ha ba ne ba ya letsomong.

Fa go sone seolo se go na le matsela, meteme, masalela a marumo le magala tse go lebegang ba ne ba di ntsha e le dimpho tsa badimo.

Dikhilomithara di le masome mararo kwa borwa bothaba go na le setlhare se sengwe sa mowana se se biditsweng ka moeti yo o neng a bidiwa Chapman yo o fetileng mo lefelong le ka dingwaga tsa bo 1870. Teng go fitlhelwa masalela a didirisiwa tsa matlapa tse di neng di dirisiwa ke batho ba ba neng ba nna foo bogologolo tala.

Go tlhabololwa ga mafelo a a nang le bokao jwa ngwao le tlholego mo tikologong ya Gweta go tla thusa mo go godiseng itsholelo ya motse oo.Lephata la Ditso Le Ditsa Tlholego le ikaelela go tlhoma matshwao a a supang kwa mafelo a a leng teng.Batho ba motse gape ba tla bona sebaka sa go thapiwa ka lenaneo la Ipelegeng go dira ditsela tse di yang kwa mafelong a.Gape go tla nna le ofisi. Le fa go ntse jalo go tlhokega gore go dirwe maiteko a go somarela matlotlo a ka thuso ya batho ba motse, gore a tle a dirisiwe mo go tsa bojanala go tswakanya itsholelo.



Baines Baobab

Kgwebe National Monument

By Vasco Baitseseng And Malebogo Seone

In 2008 Dr. Ashley Ceri of the University College of London and the authors of this article undertook an archaeological research in the Kgwebe Hills in the Ngamiland District. One of the major objectives of the research was to investigate the arrival of the Batawana in the region using the archaeological method to confirm what had been documented in historical records.

Historical information shows that the Batawana migrated into the region, entering it through Kgwebe hills after their split with the Bangwato during the Mfecane wars. The Batawana managed to defeat various ethnic groups in the region as most of these groups, like the Basubiya, Bayei and various Khoi groups were poorly organized, both politically and militarily. Ngamiland was known for its role in the long distance trade in the region, especially trade in ivory. The ivory was exchanged for external goods like cloth, beads and sugar, but most importantly guns. This trade became the single most important way of generating wealth for the Batawana royal family.

Another important factor in the history of Ngamiland is the role of missionaries, especially members of the London Missionary Society (LMS). However, the LMS failed to establish a mission station among the Batawana until the 1890s. The key reasons for this delay was the threat posed by malaria in the area, lack of competition from rival mission groups and the insignificant threat from the Boers (Tlou, 1989).

It was only on 5 August 1893 that they sent Reverend Wookey and an artisan named J.E Reid to establish a mission station at the Kgwebe Hills, a less malaria infested area. However malaria forced Reverend Wookey to leave Ngamiland in 1898. Reid had already left after being attacked by a leopard. As such the mission house was forced to close down (ibid). Though the remains of the church collapsed, they are still visible just outside Mr. Jon Dalsegg's modern game farm. For the past three years we have excavated at various areas, including the church remains, European residential place as well as what we consider to be Batawana pre-colonial settlement in the Kgwebe Hills.

In 2009, we excavated two units at KWH 4 located in the vicinity of the Kgwebe hills and characterized by numerous stone walls, enclosures and stone cairns. We focused on what was identified as a midden. One of the units was set right across the midden with an 8 × 1m trench. The site was very rich with artifacts ranging from bones, pottery and beads (both ostrich egg shell beads and glass beads). Bones were recovered in large quantities. The material is still to be shipped to the University College of London for further analysis by a faunal specialist, Dr. Andrew Reid. His analysis will hopefully shed light on whether the people relied on domestic animals, wild animals or both.



a) The 8×1 m trench set across a midden at KWH 4



b) Sieving in progress at KWH 4

Another site that has been excavated since 2008 to the present is KWH 1, otherwise referred to as the Church Trail in the 100 Monuments document (Baitseseng et. al, 2010). When excavating the site we erroneously thought it was the remains of the LMS church but subsequent evidence has indicated that these buildings were in fact a white residential area. This was confirmed by the recovery of objects like toys corrugated iron sheets, nails, hinges, glass beads, broken China ware and other 'modern' goods.
during the 2009 field trip and information from oral sources (e.g. Noster Galemediwe). The church remains have since been established to be situated less than a kilometer south east of KWH 1.

A survey was carried out with the aim of recording any area we deemed to be a site in the National Museum site record sheets. GPS coordinates of the sites were taken and the sites were described in detail. Apart from discovering sites through our own initiatives, the other method we utilized was the assistance of locals who showed us sites they knew. Mr. Xwanyere Keresemose showed us the 'caves' or water holes that the people of Somelo talked fondly about during the implementation of the 100 Monuments project (Baitseseng et.al). Ms. Norster Galemediwe joined us during the last week of the survey. She showed us some of the interesting sites in the area. Most importantly, she identified some of the hills by name.

In 5 weeks, we managed to record more than 20 new sites in the area. Most of the sites were either on hill tops or at the foot of the hills. This could either be the settlement preference of the people of the area in the olden days or we were unable to identify the sites on the plains. The other explanation is that the vegetation cover, especially grass, was very thick and as such it was not easy to see artifacts like pottery if they were not accompanied by the more visible stone walls/enclosures. Most of the enclosures/walls are similar to those at KWH 4.

One interesting site that was discovered, apart from the 'caves' noted above, was what could be possibly referred to as a 20th century 'small European traders village'. This site is found at GPS coordinate S 20°35"63.6, E 073°03"94.7'. It is characterized by what looks like rectangular house foundations, platforms and enclosures. The site is situated on the western edge of a small hill that is found on the south western side of Modimo-oteng cattle post. The foundations are similar to those found at the LMS mission station and European residential place about 5km down south (KWH 1). The difference with KWH 1 is that this site is much more extensive. Our preliminary assessment has revealed at least 15 house foundations, platforms and enclosures, all rectangular but of varying sizes.

One of the assignments the team had to undertake was to meet Mr. Dalsegg, the farm owner with a number of heritage sites located inside his wild game farm. Some of these are to be developed through the 100 Monument Project (Baitseseng et. al). The idea was to appraise him on the details of the project and share with him the National Museum's vision. The authors explained to him that the project is meant to enhance the protection, conservation and management of heritage sites and to alleviate poverty through heritage tourism. The project is also aimed at economic diversification in order to reduce our over reliance on diamond revenues that were badly affected by the recent economic recession. The people of Kgwebe and Toteng have since benefited from the initiative as they were engaged through the Ipelegeng Programme to develop access roads and trails to some of the sites discussed above. Signage is to be installed in the near future. The people will further benefit in future as some will be hired to work as site custodians, guides, form a Community Trust and be able to sell their products in curio shops to be established .

Mr. Dalsegg, was very much receptive to the proposed initiative. He explained that he had been busy introducing game animals into his farm and building a lodge with the ultimate goal of attracting tourists to this pristine landscape. He even had plans to reconstruct the old LMS church building and use the rich cultural resources in its vicinity to lure tourists to his farm. So we advised him to embrace the Museum's Adopt a Monument initiative, "a partnership program for sustainable involvement and participation of members of the public, non-governmental organizations and the business community in the management and conservation of Botswana's cultural and natural heritage sites" (Adopt a Monument Document).

Our preliminary results show that it is possible to intertwine cultural tourism with the more popular wild life based tourism. This could be achieved if the National Museum's Adopt a Monument strategy can be rolled out to even rural landscapes with outstanding heritage resources.

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Adopt a Monument Document Document

Ka ngwaga wa 2008 Dr Ashley Ceri go tswa kwa Yunivesithing ya Lontone le bakwadi ba pego e ba ne ba dira dipatlisiso kwa dithabeng tsa Kgwebe mo kgaolong ya Ngami.Maikaelelo a dipatlisiso tse e ne e le go tlhomamisa se se setseng se kwadilwe mo dikwalong tsa ditso ka ga go goroga ga Batawana mo kgaolong e.

Ditso di supa fa Batawana ba hudugetse mo kgaolong e ba tsena ka tsone dithaba tse tsa Kgwebe morago ga go kgaogana le Bangwato ka nako ya dintwa tsa Mfecane. Ba ne ba kgona go fenya merafe e mengwe e e neng e le foo jaaka Basubiya, Bayei, Bakhoi jalo jalo, e e neng e sa itsetsepela mo go tsa sepolotiki le itshireletso. Lefelo le la Ngami le ne le itsege ka seabe sa lone mo ditirisanyong tsa kgwebo fa gare ga mafelo a a katologaneng bogolo jang kgwebo ya dinaka tsa ditlou.Dinaka tse di ne di ananngwa ka dithoto di tshwana matsela, dibaga, sukiri le dithobolo. Kgwebo e e ne e le yone tsela e e botlhokwa go di gaisa tsotlhe ya go kokoanya dikhumo e e neng e dirisiwa ke ba bogosi jwa goo Tawana.

Ntlha nngwe ya botlhokwa ke seabe sa bareri ba lefoko la Modimo bogolo jang ba ba neng ba tswa kwa lekgotleng la London Missionary Society, mo ditsong tsa kgaolo e.
Go ne ga seka ga kgonega go simolodisa tiro ya go tsamaisa efangedi mo kgaolong e go fitlhelela mo dingwageng tsa bo 1890 .Tiego e e ne ya bakiwa ke go bo kgaolo eo e ne e tshabelelwa ke bolwetse jwa letshoroma. Se sengwe e ne e le go tlhoka phadisanyo go tswa mo makgotleng a mangwe le matshosetsi go tswa mo Maburung.

Go ne ga kgonagala hela ka kgwedi ya Phatwe e le malatsi a le matlhano ka ngwaga wa 1893 go romela Moruti Wookey le Rre J.E Reid go simolodisa tiro e kwa Kgwebe ka jaana bolwetse jwa letshoroma bo ne bo se bontsi thata mo lefelong leo ka nako eo. Le fa go ntse jalo bo ne jwa gola le go tsaya phekelo e sele go fithelela Moruti Wookey a tshwanelwa ke go tswa mo lefelong leo ka 1898.Rre Reid ene o ne a setse a tsamaile morago ga a sena go tlhaselwa ke lengau. Ka jalo ntlo ya kobamelo kgotsa kereke e ne ya tshwanelwa ke go tswalwa.Le fa dikago tsa yone di ne tsa felela di phuthama di santse di bonala fa ntle ga polase ya diphologolo ya ga rre Jon Dalsegg.

Dingwaga tse tharo tse di ntseng di feta ba lekalana la kepo masalela a ditso ba ntse ba epa go dira dikanoko mo go lone lefelo le kereke e e leng mo go lone, kwa Batawana ba neng ba thibelela teng mo dithabeng tsa Kgwebe le kwa go neng go nna baagedi ba ba tswang kwa Yuropa.

Mo masalelelng a bonno jo bo neng bo le mo dithabeng tsa Kgwebe go fitlhetswe marapo, dinkgwana le dibaga. Kwa go neng go nna baagedi ba ba tswang Yuropa gone go ne go na le didirisiwa tse di tshamekisiwang ke bana le dilwana tsa mo ntlong. Mo masaleleng a kereke go fitlhetswe disanke,dipekere, dibaga jalo jalo.

Sengwe gape se se neng sa dirwa ke go buisanya le rre Jon Dalsegg yo go nang le mafelo a a nang le bokao jwa ngwao le ditso a a leng mo polaseng ya gagwe ya diphologolo.
Maikaelelo e ne e le go mo tlhalosetsa ka maitlamo a lephata la Ditso le Ditsa Tlholego a go tlhabolola mafelo a a tshwanang le ao. O ne a dumalana le moono oo wa lephata le go amogela kgakololo ya gore a o eme nokeng ka lenaneo la go thusana le lephata mo go diragatseng ditlhabololo tsa go nna jalo.Go supagala gore go ka kgonagala go tshwaraganya bojanala jo bo diragalang mo mafelong a a nang le bokao jwa ngwao le tlholego le jo bo diragalang mo mafelong a diphologolo go tla ka maduo a a itumedisang.



Bonninton Farm 1



Bonninton Farm 2

BONNINGTON FARM

By Tshepo Poitshego

The launch of Phase 1 of the Bonnington Farm Project was the culmination of almost five years of preparatory work. Now that the pomp and ceremony has passed, the question on many peoples' minds is "what's next?" The long-term vision of the Department for the site, is to develop it into an open-air museum, fitness park and (heritage) learning centre.

Bonnington Farm is one of the most strategically placed heritage sites in the greater Gaborone heritage trail. It has the potential to do better than other sites included in the aforementioned heritage trail in terms of diversifying the tourism sector by improving heritage tourism.

Tourism diversification is a new concept in Botswana, since the tourism sector is dependent mainly on wildlife. Apart from that , most of the "successful" tourism ventures are based in the Chobe and Ngamiland Districts. This means that the rest of the country contributes comparatively less in the tourism sector than these two districts. The Minister of Environment, Wildlife and Tourism (MEWT), Honourable Kitso Mokaila has spoken on numerous occasions about the benefits of moving away from depending on wildlife-based tourism by introducing other diverse yet economically beneficial and viable tourism ventures. These benefits are best summarized by Gaborekwe (2009) in his article, as he states that such ventures have the "…ultimate goal of reducing pressure on …" the environment.

Heritage Tourism basically means using the different elements of people's way of life to attract tourists. The Department of National Museum and Monuments has already initiated heritage tourism projects at a few sites. One of those sites is the Tsodilo World Heritage Site where the Department was working with the Tsodilo Community Development Trust (Gaborekwe 2009) to run a curio shop. This has created employment as two permanent members of staff were hired. Another one is the Mogonye site where the Mmamotshwane Conservation Trust was involved in sourcing and securing funds to be used to construct a gatehouse. Bonnington Farm presents another opportunity for the Department to take heed of our Honourable Minister's plea and venture into tourism diversification.

Bonnington Farm stands a good chance of success in this regard due to its location, flora and fauna, architecture and history. The farm lies directly opposite the Grand Palm Hotel Casino and Resort, a 5-star rated, internationally acclaimed establishment which attracts high profile guests. Some of these guests are heads of state and multinational corporations. Along with the general public, these high profile guests present us (as a Department) with the challenge of providing world-class services so that they may be interested in returning to our site.

Provision of world-class services goes beyond providing fancy facilities on site. It translates into developing activity plans tailored to suit our various stakeholders. For example, with the help of the Education Division, school children could take part in regular themed mini-expos. Their schools could be invited to show-case aspects of "farm life" using media such as performance (drama), arts and crafts (drawings etc) and written works. Activities like these would complement the existing permanent displays and educational lectures, as well as diversify the services that the Department offers its various stakeholders.

The general consensus amongst the general public is that the museum as an institution has become irrelevant to society. Through the Bonnington farm the Department has a chance to re-affirm its importance especially in a world where cultural tourism is a growing trend.

We could make use of this concept of heritage tourism at Bonnington Farm by establishing a guided tour service through which tourists could be taken to various sites around Gaborone. This could be made possible by forming partnerships with tour operators, as has been done with those in Maun.

Apart from tourism diversification, Bonnington Farm also offers the opportunity for the Department to contribute to the Government's economic diversification drive by opening a mini crafts centre for vendors to sell their wares.

In conclusion, Bonnington Farm has the potential to revive the image of the Department of National Museum and Monuments. It will enable the department to take its place as a leading heritage authority in Botswana.



Bonninton Farm 3



Bonninton Farm 4

Reference Cited

Gaborekwe, R. 2009. Cultural Tourism in the fringes of the Okavango Delta. In The Zebra's Voice. Edition 1, 2009.

Go simolodisiwa ga legato la ntlha la tiro ya go tlhabololo polase ya Bonnington go e dira lefelo la ditso go ne go tsisa ko bokhutlong dipaakanyo tse di tsereng dingwaga tse tlhano.Mme jaanong ka go ipelela tshimolodiso ya tiro e go fitile, batho ba ipotsa gore jaanong go tla diragala eng.Tebelopele ya lephata la Ditso le Ditsa Tlholego ke go tlhabolola polase ya Bonnington go e dira motlobo wa Ditso o gape e leng lefelo la thuto, boikhutso le ikatiso.

Polase e e mo lefelong le le siametseng bojanala mo toropong kgolo ya Gaborone.Se se dira gore e nne le bokgoni ja go dira botoka go na le mafelo a mangwe a ditso mo go tswakanyeng bojanala ka go akaretsa le go tlhabolola mafelo a a nang le bokao jwa ditso, ngwao le tlholego.

Tswakanyo ya bojanala ke mogopolo o mosha mo Botswana ka jaana bojanala bo ntse bo remeletse thata mo diphologolong. Gape bontsi jwa dikgwebo tse di atlegileng tsa bojanala di kwa dikgaolong tsa Chobe le Ngami. Se se se raya gore dikgaolo tse dingwe tsa lefatshe leno di felela di nna le seabe se se seng kalo mo bojanaleng.Tona wa tsa Tikologo,Diphologolo le Bojanala Rre Kitso Mokaila o buile makgetho a le mantsi gore bojanala bo seka ja baya fela mo diphologolong mme bo tswakanngwe le dilo tse dingwe tse di ka nnang le dipoelo.

Tswakanyo e e ka dirwa ka go ngokela bajanala kwa mafelong a a nang le bokao jwa ditso, ngwao le tlholego. Gore go ngokiwe bajanala ka mokgwa o go supiwa dilo tse di farologaneng ka matshelo a batho ba dingwao tse di farologaneng.Lephata la Ditso le Ditsa Tlholego le setse le simolotse ditiro tse di amanang le bojanala jwa mofuta o mafelong a tshwana Tsodilo le Mogonye.Mo mafelong a otlhe lephata le ne le dirisanya le makgotla a a tsamaisang ditiro tsa one. Polase ya Bonnington e fa lephata tshono e nngwe ya gore le diragatse kopo ya ga tona ya gore bojanala bo kabakanngwe.

Mogopolo o o ka kgona go atlega mo polasing ya Bonnington ka ntlha ya lefelo le e leng mo go lone, diphologolo, dimela le dikago tse di fitlhelwang mo go yone mmogo le ditso tse di bonwang teng.Polase e, e lebagane le otele ya Grand Palm ya manobonobo e e itsegeng lefatshe ka bophara. Otele e ebile e etelwa ke baeng ba maemo a kwa godimo jaaka baeteledipele ba mafatshe le ba dikompone tse di kgolo. Tsholofelo ke gore se se tla dira gore lephata le leke ka bojotlhe go ba fa ditirelo tsa maemo a a kwa godimo gore ba tle ba kgatlhegele go etela polase e gape.

Go fa baeng ditirelo tsa maemo a a kwa godimo ga go reye go tsenya ditlamelo tse di turang fela. Go raya le gore go duwe ka mananeo a a tshwanetseng mefuta e e farologanyeng ya baeti. Sekai ke gore bana ba sekolo ba ka nna ba kopiwa go tla go supa ditiro tse di tsamaisanang le botshelo jwa moraka, ba dirisa metshameko, botaki tiro ya diatla le mekwalo.Ditiragalo tsa go nna jaana,di ka oketsa ditirelo tse lephata leno le di fang baeng

Batho ka bontsi ba akanya gore Lephata la Ditso le Ditsa tlholego ga le sa tlhole le na le mosola mo matshelong a setshaba a gompieno.Le fa go ntse jalo polase e ya Bonnington e le fa sebaka sa go supa gore seo ga se nnete,bogolo jang mo dinakong tse bojanala mo mafelong a a nang le bokao jwa ngwao le tlholego bo golang.

Sengwe se se ka dirwang ke go tsamaisa baeti/bajanala le lefelo le ba bo ba ya go bontshiwa matlotlo a mangwe a ditso le tlholego mo Gaborone.Se se ka kgonagala fa go dirisanngwa le batsamaisi ba dikgwebo tsa mesepele ya bojanala jaaka go dirilwe kwa Maun.

Polase e ya Bonnington gape e fa lephata le tshono ya go nna le seabe mo maitlamong a puso a go tswakanya itsholelo ka go tlhoma mafelo a batho ba ka rekisetsang mo go one dithoto tsa bone tse ba di itiretseng ka diatla. Ditirelo tsa go nna jaana di ka tsosolosa serodumo sa lephata le ba le itsiwe e le lone le di gogang kwa pele mo go tsa tshomarelo boswa jwa ngwao le tlholego mo Botswana.



Bonninton Farm 5